Summary

Phew! That was quite a chapter; we covered a lot of ground and well done for making it this far. Believe me, writing it was no picnic either. I have some good news: the next giant chapter is actually going to be a lot less work because much of what we've learned in this one is transferable.

Let's recap quickly. We started with the basics: declaring functions with names, their parameters, and how to call them with or without arguments. We then looked at passing arguments by reference, how to define default arguments, and how to return data. Next came the type declaration system in all its glory and the more advanced parameter handling of PHP 8. Then came the really big stuff: lexical scope and namespacing (and learning those topics will serve us very well when we finally move onto objects in detail). As well as all of that, we also covered anonymous functions and variable functions and had a brief discussion on a rather large topic called functional programming (and trust me, we only skimmed the surface on that).

All of the rules and features concerning functions that we have studied in this chapter are (with the odd caveat here or there) also applicable to objects, because objects are at heart simply collections of functions. Scope, data types, namespacing… it's all going to look very familiar. In the meantime, feel free to have a short break. You've earned it.